

What's your view on the environmental impact of AI tools like Copilot?

Posted by u/ReadySteadyXL • 0 points • 3 comments

This topic comes up a lot in my tech-adoption sessions, and I'd love to hear how this community sees it. There's plenty of debate around energy use, carbon footprint, and whether the overall impact of AI is a genuine concern or sometimes overstated.

****What's your take on the environmental impact of AI?****

Curious to hear a mix of perspectives.

Comments

u/martin_81 • 1 points • 2026-02-02 23:41 UTC

AGI is the most likely solution to sustainable energy, if we don't get that we're probably fucked anyway because getting any sort of geo-political agreement to stop burning fossil fuels seems very unlikely right now.

u/RealLordDevien • 2 points • 2026-01-29 16:43 UTC

Sure. The problem we need to address and discuss most is how bad the 1% of energy we use on ALL datacenters (not just ai) is for the environment. Even if it is electricity that can also be generated by e.g. solar. It certainly is not the fact that we burn all fossil fuels humans can get their hand on instead of investing in renewables. It's certainly not that we pollute every m² on earth with plastic, fly twice a year just to relax somewhere. Or use half the space on earth to grow animals to eat them. Continue to burn down woods for more meat despite ravaging wildfires. Or destroy any kind of balanced ecosystem just for a small financial gain. Should I continue? Sorry but people that cry about AI on the internet on their iPhone while streaming HD vids on background all day are hypocrites

u/ChampionshipComplex • 3 points • 2026-01-29 16:38 UTC

It's a bit bizarre - If we seriously wanted to cut back on unnecessary computer usage, what about stopping the bitcoin mining, or the fact that over 50% of social media accounts now are apparently bots. What about the compute associated with spam.

Copilot is hosted by Microsoft who are committed to being carbon negative in the next 4 years.

u/Yalarii • 3 points • 2026-01-29 13:22 UTC

It's certainly problematic. But it is not up to the individual user to worry about. There should be more petitions to the companies creating them to invest in carbon capture programs to offset their server use.

u/lilyzbby • 1 points • 2026-03-31 00:04 UTC

I wonder if those petitions would ever elicit action if it's not up to the individual user to worry about? Who would be the ones who call for companies to change if it isn't us, the users? Would it be other companies? Governments? How would we get our governments to care if we don't care to begin with?